

Chapter 4 – Metasploit Framework

Part 6 – Meterpreter Fundamentals (Conceptual Guide)

What is Meterpreter?

Meterpreter is an advanced interactive environment provided by certain Metasploit payloads after successful exploitation during authorized security assessments. It supports information gathering, file interaction, process inspection, network review, and post-exploitation workflows.

Meterpreter vs Command Shell

Meterpreter offers a richer, extensible interface, while a traditional command shell provides basic operating system command execution.

Sessions

A session represents an active connection to a target during an authorized assessment. Multiple sessions may be managed simultaneously.

Typical Activities

Identify the operating system, determine the current user context, inspect running processes, review network configuration, gather evidence, and document findings.

Evidence & Best Practices

Collect only information relevant to the assessment, minimize changes to the target, document observations, close sessions when testing is complete, and include evidence in the final report.

Common Mistakes

Making unnecessary changes, failing to document findings, collecting irrelevant data, and leaving sessions open after testing.

Quick Revision

Meterpreter is designed for post-exploitation in authorized environments. The goal is validation, evidence collection, and reporting—not simply obtaining access.